

NOTES

The Fifth Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

Monday, March 7, 2022

Regular Meeting: 6:30 PM

To be held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall.

Also available through Zoom.

Vice Chair Jenny Graham - sitting at the head. Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn attending via Zoom.

6:34 PM Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives

Present: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin (on Zoom), Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn (on Zoom).

No student reps present.

Salute the Flag

Consent Agenda

- Approval of Bills/Payrolls
- Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 2.28.2022

Motion to approve: Kathy Kreatz/Paul Ruseau

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 consent agenda approved.

Report of the Superintendent

- 1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent**

We meet tonight on the anniversary of Bloody Sunday, which took place March 7, 1965 in Selma, Alabama. Over 600 people marched in a civil rights demonstration that ended in violence as state troopers attacked the marchers as they made their way over the Edmund Pettus Bridge. The violence was televised nationwide and led to demonstrations across the nation against this horrific event. The outrage led to the passage of the Voting Rights Act of 1965, which President Johnson said at the time, "it is our effort to right that wrong". I mention this because we have all heard about various states who are considering bills which could limit voting rights for Americans. We must remain vigilant as voting rights are one of the most sacred rights we have.

As stated in my Friday message, we are seeking interested parents and community members to participate as members of a Playground Advisory Committee. The members of this committee will work with the

selected vendor for the design of the McGlynn Middle & Elementary Universally Accessible Playground. This work will allow this group to make recommendations to improve accessibility at the other school playgrounds in Medford. To apply, please see the link on the Blog or email Dr. Cushing at pcushing@medford.k12.ma.us.

Congratulations to the Mustangs Winter Guard who took home first place in its division at the annual Home Show. The Mustangs competed against over a dozen winter guards. They performed using energetic music and a combination of flags, sabers, rifles, and dance that wowed the crowds.

Also, congratulations are in order for the Mustang Basketball Cheerleaders, who placed third in the state Regional Tournament yesterday. They will move onto the State Tournament next weekend at Worcester State University. Good luck Mustangs!

The Mustangs Winter Sports Season is now completed. The Boys Basketball Team made the MIAA Tournament, losing by 5 points to Melrose. We applaud our winter sport athletes: girls & boys basketball, girls & boys ice hockey, girls & boys indoor track and gymnastics for their dedication and commitment. These teams had to fight through a Covid-filled winter season. Still they prevailed. Spring Sport Tryouts begin March 21st. The high school will be adding Boys Volleyball and the Middle Schools will offer Flag Football and Outdoor Track. Additionally, I would like to add that I have seen the MHS Drama Club practicing for the Legally Blonde Musical, which will be presented in early April.

UPCOMING EVENTS:

Medford SEPAC hosts their monthly meeting by Zoom on Wednesday, March 9th at 7 PM. The topic will be: Declarative Language.

Also on Wednesday, the Medford Public Schools collaborating with Medford's Board of Health, will be hosting a free vaccine clinic from 3-6 PM. Covid vaccines and flu shots will be available.

An Important Note! The In person Building Bridges to Kindergarten has been rescheduled from Wednesday, March 9th to next Wednesday, March 16th at 6:30 -7:30 PM in the Library at Medford High School. Also, the Parent Information Center will remain open on the 16th until 6 PM for registrations.

The Spotlight Theater Company is presenting an Adaptive Musical Theater Workshop that began Saturday and will continue Saturdays until April 30th. There will be a showcase at the end of the workshop. It's open to students aged 8-18 and for all abilities. For further information, please visit spotlightmedford.com

This Sunday, March 13th, Daylight Savings Time Begins! Don't forget to set clocks 1 hour ahead! Spring Forward!

Tomorrow is International Women's Day when we celebrate women and imagine a gender equal world, free of bias, stereotypes and a world that is diverse, equitable and inclusive. Together let us forge ahead for women's equality, #BreaktheBias.

March 18th, our Hindu neighbors will be celebrating Holi, a religious festival of colors. It celebrates the triumph of good over evil and the changing of the seasons from winter to spring. Let me take this opportunity to extend best wishes to our Hindu families for a Happy and Healthy Holi.

Finally, the horror of war and unchecked aggression are on display as the world observes the Russian invasion of Ukraine. It is so important that we all remember our Ukrainian neighbors and pray for peace. The high school's CCSR produced a wonderful show of support Friday night for Ukraine. I would like to thank Senator Pat Jehlen and School Committee Member Paul Ruseau for attending. For those in our community who might be interested in helping the Ukrainian people, donations are being accepted by Unicef. Additionally, the McGlynn Middle School's CCSR are collecting: first aid items (such as bandaids, gauze, medical scissors, antibiotic creams, Tylenol, & Advil), flashlights & batteries, toiletries, (such as deodorant, toothpaste & toothbrushes) and books until March 11th.

2. [COVID Update](#) - Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy and Avery Hines Director of Health Services will report on operational updates and pending COVID shifts in the Medford Public Schools.

Dave Murphy: I mentioned last week that we would speak about masking on buses tonight. Effective March 14, masks will be optional on Eastern Buses. Regarding specialized transportation services, families will be notified later this week. Test results showed declining rates. Over 2700 students have signed up for the rapid testing program. Participation requires reporting of positive results. Our last vaccination clinic will take place this Wednesday. In the event people choose to get their first shot at this clinic will be able to get the second shot at City Hall/Board of Health. Last week we concluded surveillance testing that was made possible through Tufts University. We express our gratitude to the staff of Tufts who have allowed us to run this successful testing over the last year and a half. Tufts has exhibited such flexibility in helping us run this testing program. Our partnership with Tufts is very unique and is very valuable to us. We are indebted for their contributions.

3. Report on proposed Integrated Mathematics programming at MHS from the Director of Mathematics Faiza Khan.

[Slides](#)
[FAQs](#)

Paul Ruseau: I am very excited about this program. How is it recorded on report cards? How will colleges know what the students have taken?

Faiza Khan: We discussed this with neighboring districts. Colleges are familiar with Integrated Math Course 1, 2 and 3. They know if a public school is offering it, what exactly is being offered in each course.

Paul Ruseau: Are there any risks regarding kids entering or leaving midstream? It is less of a risk since we are keeping the traditional pathway for now as well.

Faiza Khan: This is one of the point that our committee discussed. The students will be supported through 1, 2 and 3 while in MPS but yes there will be challenges with it. First half is Algebra, second half is Geometry. We are trying to find a solution to that right now.

Paul Ruseau: For students who may or may not be on an IEP, I want to make sure that students who land here don't get derailed by the pathways. We do have a high turnover rate of students. Does this create any problems for MCAS?

Faiza Khan: This pathway will be a better preparation for MCAS. MCAS has Algebra, Geometry and Statistics in it. Covering the same standards just in different sequence. That is the hope.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: DESE is supporting this Pathway. The number of students who have to take remedial math in college is concerning. I believe that this approach of teaching algebra and geometry in the same year will be helpful to many students, especially to those who consider themselves as math averse. If we want to see different outcomes, we want to try to teach Math in a different way. I believe it will catch momentum in other districts soon.

Kathy Kreatz: I wish that we had this pathway back when my son was at the MVTHS. Will co-taught courses be offered?

Faiza Khan: Definitely. It will be available for all students.

Kathy Kreatz: Will there be a decision date? Or a date when students will find out which pathway?

Faiza Khan: Paul D'Alleva has been presenting this information the High School and middle schools. We always take parent recommendations over every other thing.

Kathy Kreatz: As we approach budget season, will we need more math teachers?

Faiza Khan: We are thinking about staffing. I am in talks with Mr. D'Alleva about this.

Sharon Hays: Has this been around for awhile in other districts in Massachusetts? How many?

Faiza Khan: We have had many guests come to visit from other districts who are teaching integrated math. Waltham is doing this. Somerville is moving in this direction. Arlington and Brookline (for at least ten years) offer it. We are following the 1/2/3 sequence that DESE has provided us. Some districts only teach one and two and then offer the students the other math electives. It has been around for a while.

4. Report on February Camp Mustang at Medford High School presented by Director of Pupil Services Joan Bowen and Assistant Superintendent of Elementary Schools Suzanne Galusi.

[Link to slides](#)

Melanie McLaughlin: This was a great model of inclusive programs in our district. My daughter had a great time and I know many others did as well.

Sharon Hays: I love the programs, especially exposing the kids to technology. Are you thinking about something like this for the summer? Parents are starting to plan summer camps now.

Suzanne Galusi: The goal behind Camp Mustang is to keep students engaged/anchored in the school community in downtime. We would be looking to do this in the month of August to transition back to school.

Mea Mustone: The laser cutter is amazing! We will have many future engineers thanks to that program.

5. Report on March 3, 2022 District Wide Professional Development. Report presented by Director of Pupil Services Joan Bowen, Assistant Superintendent of Elementary Schools Suzanne Galusi and Assistant Superintendent of Secondary Schools Dr. Peter Cushing and Carmen Williams, Supt. in Residence

[Link to slides](#)

New Business

- 2022-21 Offered by Paul Ruseau

The Medford School Committee shall authorize one member to attend Medford City Council Public Health and Community Safety meetings regarding the proposed Civilian Control Over Public Surveillance Ordinance to provide input and consider compliance with relevant student privacy laws.

Paul Ruseau: The City Council is drafting a new ordinance regarding use of cameras. I am concerned that the City Council is not thinking about education as they draft this ordinance. If you select me, I will insist that they pass it through Education Law legal services. Use of body cameras on school property needs to be addressed by a member of our group. The next meeting is on March 16th. If members approve this, I do volunteer.

Mea Mustone: Is the school administration part of this group?

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: I have not spoken to Chief Buckley regarding this ordinance. I will plan to speak with him.

Mea Mustone: Are you able to do this?

Paul Ruseau : We as a body can certainly appoint a body to represent us but I do not have voting rights in City Council. All ordinances go through legal review but I just want to make sure there is no blind spot. Would police camera footage on a school campus be a violation of FERPA? Since I wouldn't be voting, I am just looking for permission to attend and speak for us. I am happy to report out at what happens at the meetings and let you know if there are concerns.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-KoeHN: I am not comfortable with someone attending on behalf of the School Community. I would recommend that the ordinance be read by our attorney Howard Greenspan. If you adjust the motion, I can see that getting us notes could be helpful.

Paul Ruseau: I understand the reservation but it sounds like I should go as a member of the public. The mayor can't speak as a member of the public because you are the mayor. I can not speak as a member of the public because I am a public official. It is a bad look. We can't insert ourselves into the ordinance creating process.

Breanna Lungo-KoeHN: In regards to the School Committee, one person can attend the city council and express an opinion. As far as one person representing all of us, you can't do it.

Jenny Graham: Is there anticipation that March 16th will be the final vote?

Mayor Breanna Lungo-KoeHN: It makes sense to have someone attend and take notes. I can't imagine it will pass that night. I can also have our legal team look at it from the school side as well.

Paul Ruseau: What if the city council passes an ordinance that is clearly a violation of law? Who sues whom? Does the ordinance say anything about turning the camera off when going into a school? It sounds like we are leaving it all out there and hoping for the best.

Melanie McLaughlin: Can we consider writing a letter as a reflection of our committee?

Jenny Graham: I believe we can but we don't meet before the 16th.

Melanie McLaughlin: I don't think it needs to be a collective effort. One member could draft the letter and share with the group.

Paul Ruseau: I have no trouble sending in comment to the city council when it comes to parking or the budget but when it has to do with schools, it seems like a stretch that we can't send a member to the meeting to represent our interests. I am happy to write the letter to remind them that school law is not regular law. My biggest concern is considering the complexity of this ordinance, knowing they got it right before it gets approved seems important. I think other communities do have a joint committee between City Council and the School Committee to discuss issues like these.

Motion not passed.

- **2022-22 Offered by Paul Ruseau, Sharon Hays and Jenny Graham**

All nurse offices in every school within the Medford Public Schools will stock an assortment of menstrual care products including tampons and pads.

Effective immediately these products will be free of charge to students who request them and students will be supplied up to 3 items at each visit to the nurse's office.

Beginning May 1, 2022 students requesting these products will be supplied sufficient quantities to meet their needs. Students will not be charged for these products

STATEMENT READ BY PAUL RUSEAU

On Thursday, March 3, Senate bill 1445 unanimously passed the Massachusetts Senate. The bill,

"An Act to Increase Access to Disposable Menstrual Products in Prisons, Homeless Shelters, and Public Schools," is the culmination of a lot of work by a lot of people - and it is important to mention the names of these people right here in Medford!

From 2016 to 2018 Maya Gomez and Willa Driscoll created the "Free the Pad" project as part of the Center for Citizenship and Social Responsibility.

From 2019-2020 Christina Zheng and Elisabeth Hunt continued and expanded this work with the "Tax-less Tampons. Free the Feminine Products" project also as part of the CCSR.

and now Melina McGovern and Marianna Konstantara are continuing this important work with their project as part of the CCSR.

Thank you Maya, Willa, Christina, Elisabeth, Melina, and Marianna!

The lead sponsor of the Senate bill is none other than our Senator Pat Jehlen.

Thank you Pat for all your work on this!

The two lead sponsors in the House are our own Representative Christine Barber and Representative Jay Livingstone of Boston.

Thank you Christine and Jay for all your work, and all the work to come as you marshall this towards becoming law.

I also want to thank the CCSR and their benefactors who ensure that the resources are available so our students can become the leaders we know they can be.

Finally, I want to thank the leadership of the Massachusetts Menstrual Equity Coalition, and the Massachusetts Chapter of the National Organization of Women for the sustained work needed to keep this important work moving forward.

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Mea Mustone

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 Motion passed.

Melanie McLaughlin: Can a letter be sent to the 6 students from CCSR who initiated this cause?

Paul Ruseau: Second

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 Motion passes.

2022-23 Offered by Jenny Graham

Whereas MPS is required to distribute notifications to caregivers regarding Truancy and Absenteeism and;

Whereas, the Medford School Committee and the MPS administration are committed to creating a collaborative partnership between home and school;

Be it resolved that the Family Engagement and Communications subcommittee will meet to review district communications regarding Truancy and Absenteeism. The committee will review our regulatory requirements and current communications to ensure there is compliance with regulations and that the letters achieve our objectives of collaborative partnership.

Jenny Graham; I know there are a lot of regulatory requirements to meet with these letters.

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Sharon Hays

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 Motion passes.

- 2022-24 Offered by Jenny Graham

Whereas the Communications, Engagement, and Strategic Planning Subcommittee met on 12/1/2020 to discuss the District Communication strategy and;

Whereas during that meeting the administration discussed goals for a new and comprehensive platform to manage communications and the need for a new website;

Be it resolved, that the Family Engagement and Communications subcommittee will meet to review progress to date, understand current efforts, discuss future efforts, and identify funding requirements to meet the goal of having a cohesive communications strategy that meets the needs of families and the district.

Jenny Graham: I was thinking about the website recently and how it doesn't contain information families are looking for. We had a great discussion about the limitations of our current platforms in the past and the ways it could be integrated with the efforts of the PTOs.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: I wanted to share that we have been working with some of our students, Ms Miller and Ms. Caldwell to roll out a new website. We took feedback that was given and will be having a presentation of the new website in April. From the December 2020 meeting, we have been working diligently on this.

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Mea Mustone

Kathy Kreatz: Should we wait until after the website release to meet on this topic?

Paul Ruseau: The website is just one piece of our communication strategy. I am concerned about the funding requirements of any changes we might need to make going forward.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: I can definitely present whatever we have to the subcommittee meeting.

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 Motion passes.

- 2022-25 Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau

The Wellness Policy (ADF) for K-8 students will be sent to the Rules & Policy Subcommittee for revision. The subcommittee shall hold at least one working session that invites members of the administration and the public to provide input on the goals and requirements of the revised policy. The recommended revised policy will be returned to this committee prior to the end of the 2021-2022 school year.

Paul Ruseau: This is a motion I put on just when the pandemic was beginning. This is the recess policy. We tabled it at that time. This is why I am offering it again so we can look at and possibly revise our recess policy.

Motion: Mea/Sharon Hays

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 Motion passes.

Next Meetings

- **Wednesday, March 9, 2022, 4:00 PM - 6:00 PM: Committee of the Whole Meeting - School Committee Rules.**
Zoom:
<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/93016448588>
- **Monday, March 21, 2022, 6:30PM: Regular School Committee Meeting - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom:**
<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/93962585795>

Adjournment:

Motion to adjourn the meeting: Mea Mustone/Kathy Kreatz

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 Meeting adjourned at 8:30.

